



dispiriting seventh place, recording only five wins from 16 matches, despite playing eight at home.

Olympic triumph

Indian men's hockey team goalkeeper P.R. Sreejesh's announcement that he would hang up his shirt after the Paris Games drew all eyes to the team as it began its campaign with a win against New Zealand. Growing stronger as the group-stage games progressed, the team unlocked its true potential by defeating powerhouse Australia for the first time since 1972.

A 10-man India then showed remarkable character to overcome Great Britain in a dramatic quarterfinal tie. However, all its hard work was undone by a clinical German performance in the

semifinal.

All was not lost, though, as team captain Harmanpreet Singh rallied his side with two goals against Spain in the bronze medal match, breaking a four-decade-long jinx and securing back-to-back Olympic podium finishes. Harmanpreet ended the tournament as the top scorer with 10 goals, seven of which came from penalty corners.

Sreejesh received a fitting farewell to his illustrious international career, which included two Commonwealth Games silver medals, three Asian Games medals (two of them gold), a World League bronze, two Champions Trophy silvers, and two Olympic bronze medals.

Continental success

Following Schopman's resignation

Doyen of the sport: Hockey India has retired the jersey number of legendary goalkeeper P.R. Sreejesh, who played a key role in securing India's second consecutive Olympic bronze medal at the Paris Games. RITU RAJ KONWAR

as head coach of the Indian women's hockey team, Harendra Singh faced a tough start in his new role during the away leg of the FIH Pro League 2023-24.

The challenges continued in January as the team failed to qualify for the Paris Games during the Olympic Qualifiers. In the Pro League, it managed only eight points from 16 matches, finishing eighth out of nine teams and narrowly avoiding relegation to the Nations Cup.